



Getting Started with Jenkins

We begin this series of articles on Jenkins with a brief overview, and a guide on how to create a Jenkins job.

Jenkins is a continuous integration server that can automatically build software without any user intervention. Jenkins also monitors externally run jobs so that the user gets periodic feedback about the execution via email, and hence can monitor the tasks. Jenkins can also be configured to periodically build software code from an open source version control system such as SVN.

Sounds amazing! Let's get started. Download the Jenkins software from the official website and install it. There is the option of downloading generic .war files or a native installer based on the system's platform. After installation, Jenkins can be accessed by simply typing `http://localhost:8080` in the browser address bar. Initially, there is nothing much on the page—just a welcome message asking for a job to be created. But before that, the security has to be set up so that only authorised users have access to Jenkins. This is very important in

a multi-user, multiple-access level situation where Jenkins is hosted on a public server or an internal network with many people accessing it for different purposes.

The 'Manage Jenkins' link on the left side of the page takes the user to the 'Settings' page with all the settings listed. The warning at the top requests the user to set up authentication. Click the 'Set up Security' button. On the next page, tick the 'Enable security' button and the detailed security settings will appear. You can select the security realm, i.e., the authentication

mechanism and the authorisation. In most real world scenarios, the 'Project Based Matrix Authorisation Strategy' is the ideal choice, as it gives different access levels to different users.

You are now ready to create the first Jenkins job.

So what exactly is a Jenkins job?

Whenever Jenkins is required to build source code, all the details about building that particular code have to be stored in Jenkins. All these details, combined with the



Figure 1: The Jenkins home page just after installation